

How to Submit Observations

Anyone can contribute to Who Eats Whom—all you need is an iNaturalist account and a photo that clearly shows one organism feeding on another.

Because feeding events typically involve **two species**, each event must be submitted to iNaturalist as **two separate observations**: one for the **eater** and one for the **organism being eaten**.

Once both observations reach *Research Grade* and are properly linked, they will automatically appear in the Who Eats Whom database.

Step 1 — Create an iNaturalist account

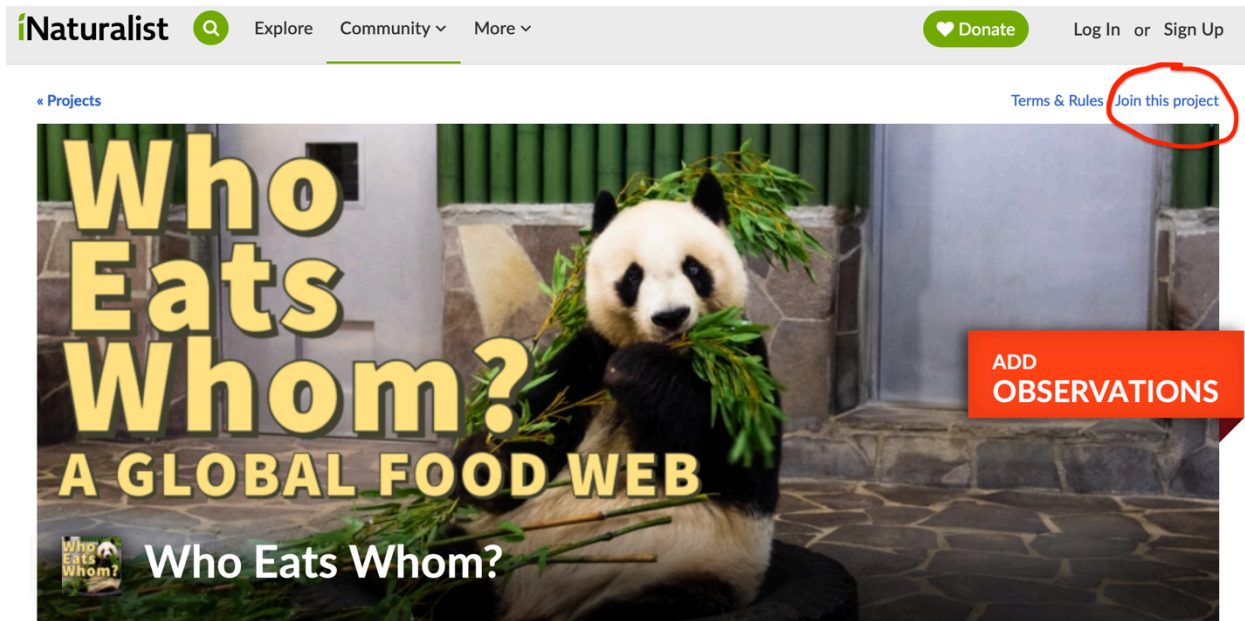
If you're new to iNaturalist, sign up at: <https://www.inaturalist.org>

Upload your photos as you normally would.

Step 2 — Join the Who Eats Whom project

Join the project by clicking “Join this project” here:
<https://www.inaturalist.org/projects/who-eats-whom>

You only need to join once.



Step 3 — Create two observations

For a single feeding event, make **two separate observations**:

1. **Observation A:** the **eater** (predator, parasite, scavenger, pollinator, etc.)
2. **Observation B:** the **organism being eaten** (prey, host, carrion, nectar source, etc.)

The image(s) in both observations should clearly document the interaction.

Step 4 — Add both observations to the project

On each observation page in iNaturalist:

1. Scroll down to the **Projects** section.
2. Add the observation to **Who Eats Whom**.

Do this for both the “eater” and the “eatee.”

✓ Projects (1)

Add to a Project

 Who Eats Whom?
Observation Fields ▾

⚙

Step 5 — Link the two observations

To ensure the interaction is recognized, the two observations must be linked in the **Observation Fields**. You will be automatically prompted to do this after you add an observation to Who Eats Whom (see screenshot below).

For **both** observations:

1. Indicate which observation is for the “eater” and which is for the “organism being eaten”
2. Paste the URL to the observation’s “partner” in the feeding interaction
3. Indicate whether the observation is any of the special/unique types of feeding (parasitism, etc.)

Filling out these observations fields allows our system to know the two records belong to the same event.

Who Eats Whom? ×

Please complete the following to add this observation to the project:

ID meant for "eater" or organism being eaten? *

eater ▾

Add

Is this observation of the "eater" or the plant/animal/fungus being eaten?

URL for "partner" observation

https://www.inaturalist.org/observations/297412624

Add

Provide the iNaturalist web address for the other observation (i.e. the "eater" or the organism being eaten)

Is observation one of these special types of feeding? *

No, none of these ▾

Add

Scavenging: eating an animal that was already dead. Pollination: visiting a flower to collect pollen/nectar. Parasitism: eating parts of an animal (e.g. blood).

* Required

Cancel

Add to Project

Step 6 — Reach Research Grade

Only interactions where **both** observations reach **Research Grade** will be added to the Who Eats Whom database.

To reach Research Grade, an observation must meet iNaturalist's standard criteria:

- a date
- a location
- a photo
- a wild organism
- a community-supported taxonomic ID agreed on by two or more users

Note that is the same data quality standard used by other sites that ingest iNaturalist data, such as GBIF. Tip: clearer photos and correct linking help other identifiers quickly verify the record.

What kinds of interactions can I submit?

Who Eats Whom accepts a wide range of feeding relationships, including:

- Predation
 - Herbivory
 - Scavenging
 - Parasitism
 - Pollination
 - Nectar feeding
 - In short, any instance where one organism is obtaining food from another
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What not to submit

- Interactions **without visible evidence** of feeding
 - Observations without a way to identify each organism
 - Captive or staged feeding events (iNaturalist rules discourage these)
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After you submit

If both observations become Research Grade and are correctly linked:

- The interaction is automatically ingested by Who Eats Whom
 - Your observation appears in our database, map, graph view, and interactive global food web
 - You help build the first global, photographic record of trophic interactions
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